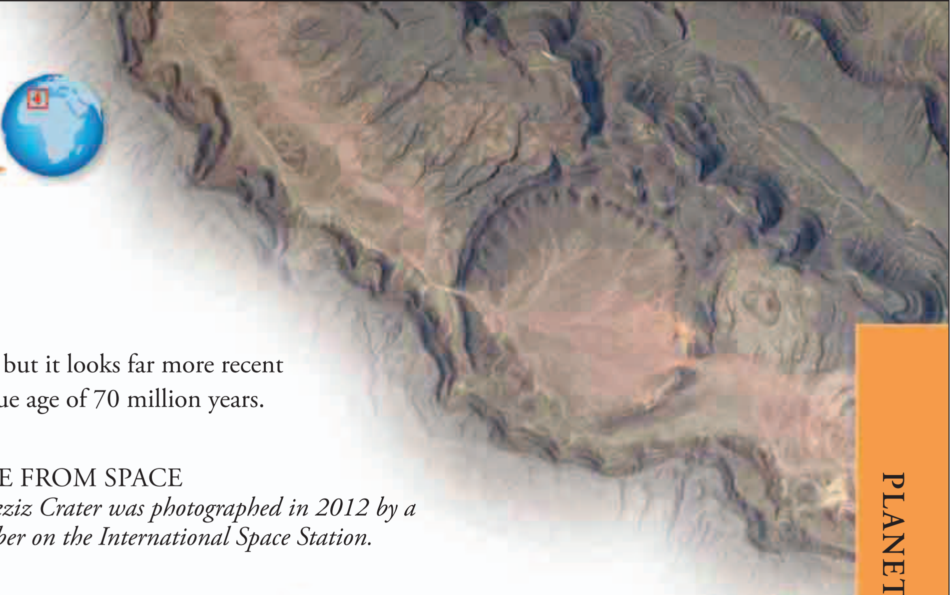


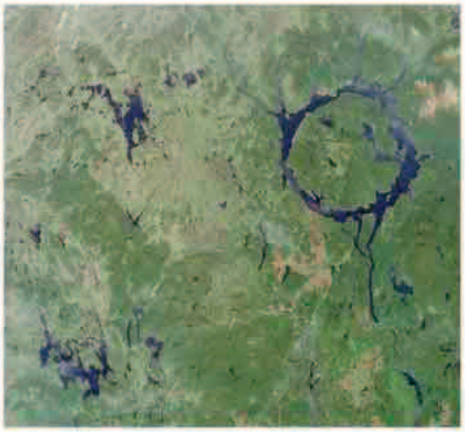
Ouarkziz Crater
Algeria

Location Northwest Algeria
Date of impact 70 million years ago
Width 2 miles (3.5 km)
Type Simple

Originally called Tindouf when it was discovered in 1997, the Ouarkziz impact crater appears as an almost perfectly circular scar in the barren layers of sedimentary rock of the northern Sahara Desert. Occasional rainstorms feed a stream that has cut across the crater, but it looks far more recent than its true age of 70 million years.

▸ VISIBLE FROM SPACE
The Ouarkziz Crater was photographed in 2012 by a crew member on the International Space Station.

Manicougan Crater
Canada



Location Québec, northwest of Montreal
Date of impact 212 million years ago
Width 60 miles (100 km)
Type Complex

After Spider Crater, this huge crater in Canada is one of the oldest that has been found. It was formed by a massive impact that made Earth's crust rebound into the peak of Mont Babel at the center of the crater. It is surrounded by the vast, ring-shaped trough of Lake Manicouagan.

Chicxulub Crater
Mexico

Location Northern coast of Yucatán
Date of impact 66 million years ago
Width Up to 150 miles (240 km)
Type Complex

Discovered by accident by an oil prospector in the late 1970s, this truly colossal crater and its rings mark the catastophic asteroid impact that almost certainly triggered the extinction of the dinosaurs 66 million years ago. It is now buried beneath later rocks, and is only detectable using high-tech surveying equipment.

Wolfe Creek Crater
Australia

Location Great Sandy Desert, Western Australia
Date of impact 300,000 years ago
Width 2,870 ft (875 m)
Type Simple

Most meteorite craters on Earth have been virtually destroyed by erosion, but recent desert sites like this one survive almost intact. It has features typical of many small craters, including a central hollow that sometimes holds water, and a circular rim covered with debris blown out by the force of the impact.

Kaali Craters
Estonia

Location Saaremaa Island, Estonia
Date of impact 4,000–10,000 years ago
Width 40–130 ft (12–40 m)
Type Complex

One of the most recent meteorite impact sites, Kaali is a group of nine craters. It was formed when a meteorite broke up into fragments several miles above the surface, each of which formed its own small crater.